

Chapter 11: Photos

Because of Feng Yue's words, Yan Lin sat stunned on the media room sofa, her mind in chaos, and for the first time, an inexplicable sense of crisis arose.

She hadn't remembered the shoe size...

She thought of the smile on Feng Yue's face when she turned to look at her before leaving, and surprisingly detected a sense of relief in it.

A woman's sixth sense clearly told Yan Lin that the current situation might not be good, but she couldn't figure out specifically why it wasn't good.

At this time, Aunt Liu's voice calling her to dinner came again, and only then did Yan Lin collect her thoughts and go downstairs.

Aunt Liu finished tidying up and left work first, so for a while, only the two dining people remained in the villa.

Yan Lin hadn't seen Feng Yue for a while, and when she saw her again this time, she inexplicably felt that Feng Yue seemed much thinner, and her complexion wasn't as good as before.

Their family had no rules about not talking during meals, but because Yan Lin was naturally taciturn, the two rarely spoke when eating at home.

But today, for some unknown reason, Yan Lin suddenly wanted to chat more with Feng Yue, whether because she felt guilty about giving shoes that didn't fit or for some other reason.

"Those photos, did you put them away?" Yan Lin was referring to some photos that Feng Yue had previously arranged around the house. Most of those photos were taken when they were in high school.

Feng Yue paused with her chopsticks, lowered her head to take a bite of food, her voice somewhat muffled, "Mm, there were too many displayed, so I put them away."

Hearing this, Yan Lin didn't know what else to say. She rubbed her fingers against the edge of the bowl for a long time, then just nodded faintly.

But this question made Feng Yue feel somewhat mixed inside.

In her previous life, their little home had also been filled with these photos of her and Yan Lin everywhere. When she had arranged them, Yan Lin had been somewhat unhappy, thinking Feng Yue was too ostentatious, and even said that if anyone came to their home, they would definitely think it inappropriate.

However, Feng Yue at that time had a lively personality and felt that it was her own home, so she could arrange it however she wanted. Besides, Yan Lin's attitude wasn't very strong at the time, so she hadn't taken down those photos.

But Feng Yue hadn't expected that in this life, when she had voluntarily put away these photos that annoyed her to look at, Yan Lin would specifically ask about them at the dinner table.

The two had nothing to talk about, so the dinner table fell into silence again.

Yan Lin felt there was something wrong with the current atmosphere, but she couldn't figure out what the problem was, so she could only mechanically eat the food that didn't really suit her taste.

When she took the first bite, she discovered that today's dinner wasn't made by Feng Yue, but by Aunt Liu.

Counting the time from her previous life, Yan Lin hadn't tasted Feng Yue's cooking for about three years. Before, because the person was gone, she endured it, but now with Feng Yue sitting in front of her, she couldn't really eat anything else.

Seeing that she ate very little and was even picky about the dishes, Feng Yue thought for a moment and asked, "Did you eat on the plane?"

"No." Yan Lin shook her head and looked up at Feng Yue.

"Then why aren't you eating?" Feng Yue roughly guessed why she wasn't eating much, but still asked on purpose, "No appetite?"

Yan Lin paused and nodded, "Something like that." After speaking, she put down her chopsticks, apparently not planning to continue eating.

Feng Yue raised her eyebrows slightly, finished the last bit of rice in her bowl in two bites, and also put down her chopsticks, "Mm, I'm done eating."

After speaking, she began clearing the bowls and chopsticks from the table.

Yan Lin hadn't expected Feng Yue to miss the meaning in her words. Wanting to say something more but finding it inappropriate to speak up, she could only obediently follow behind Feng Yue to clear the table.

After dinner, with nothing else to do, Feng Yue sat in the living room as usual, planning to watch some TV to aid digestion, take her medicine, and then go upstairs to shower and sleep.

Yan Lin should have gone upstairs to handle company matters, but for some reason, she quietly sat down next to Feng Yue.

A variety show was playing on TV, with entertainers trying various tricks hoping to make the TV audience laugh, but at this moment, the two viewers in front of the TV hadn't even smiled once.

Yan Lin looked at the TV, but her gaze inexplicably drifted to the TV cabinet, and for the first time, she felt that the top of their TV cabinet looked a bit empty.

What had originally been placed there was a picture frame containing a group photo of her, Feng Yue, and Fu Sixue.

As for why Fu Sixue was also in it, it was because she and Feng Yue had pitifully few photos together alone, with their only solo photo placed by Feng Yue on the bedside table in their bedroom.

"Won't you put the photos back?" Yan Lin's voice was flat, making it difficult to detect any emotion in it.

Yan Lin's voice came suddenly, but Feng Yue just shook her head faintly and replied, "No, it wouldn't look good if others saw them."

Yan Lin clenched and then loosened her fingers, "Oh."

This was their home - why should they care whether others thought it looked good or not?

Later, the two didn't continue talking, just quietly watching TV, though who knows how much they actually absorbed.

About half an hour later, Feng Yue checked the time on her phone, then stood up to take out her medicine and poured herself a glass of warm water.

Yan Lin had no interest in that TV program to begin with, and now she focused all her attention on Feng Yue.

Until she saw Feng Yue take out a pile of medicine bottles, she remembered the phone call Wei Yuran had made to her before returning to the country.

Feng Yue had quite a lot of medicine - painkillers, medication to control her condition, drugs to reduce intracranial pressure¹ - all spread out in a small collection.

Feng Yue arranged the pills according to the doctor's instructions one by one, then swallowed them one by one with water.

Her throat was quite narrow, so taking medicine was rather difficult for her. Each time she took medicine, it was almost like torture.

Yan Lin watched her tilt her head back and swallow again and again, even seeing some tears seep from the corners of her eyes. Somehow, she began to feel sorry for Feng Yue.

Feng Yue didn't avoid Yan Lin when taking her medicine, and Yan Lin didn't show surprise at her taking medicine either. Both were well aware of this matter.

After Feng Yue swallowed the last pill, she almost retched from discomfort. At this moment, a hand suddenly reached out beside her, with a fruit-flavored hard candy in the palm. This hand was slender with distinct knuckles, and the rounded nails added a touch of gentleness to this hand.

Feng Yue was stunned for two seconds before unwrapping the candy and putting it in her mouth, saying thanks indistinctly, "Thank you."

Yan Lin said nothing, only after seeing her recover did she ask, "Your illness, how is it?"

"Just like that." Feng Yue smiled somewhat indifferently, "Dr. Wei should have explained it to you quite clearly."

Yan Lin frowned. She didn't know if Feng Yue was angry, but her instinct told her she should apologize.

"Sorry."

Feng Yue's movement to get up paused, as if she had heard something incredible, even her breathing became somewhat rapid.

Yan Lin didn't know what was wrong, just wanted to reach out to help her, but Feng Yue suddenly backed away, just like when she had avoided her in the media room earlier.

Yan Lin's outstretched hand froze in mid-air, and Feng Yue also knew her reaction was too strong. But this wasn't her fault.

Who could have expected it? Yan Lin, who hadn't apologized when she said such hurtful words on their anniversary, would inexplicably say sorry to her today.

It was really too ridiculous.

She, who had always longed for Yan Lin's apology, was too ridiculous.

Feng Yue straightened up and forced down the nauseous feeling in her heart, swallowed, and said, "There's nothing to apologize for. I'm going upstairs first."

After speaking, she went upstairs without looking back.

Yan Lin sat there dazed, blinking and lowering her eyelashes. This was the first time she felt somewhat at a loss in front of Feng Yue.

At that moment just now, she had even sensed deep disgust from Feng Yue toward her.

It was precisely this emotion that made Yan Lin freeze in place, unable to say a word for a moment.

Feng Yue went straight to the guest room, and only after she collapsed on the bed and recovered for a while did she suppress the urge to vomit in her heart.

The fruit candy in her mouth had completely dissolved, and a sticky sweet feeling clung to Feng Yue's tongue tip, lingering for a long time.

After Yan Lin went upstairs, she stood in front of her room door for a moment, not knowing how to face Feng Yue in the room. If Feng Yue still felt that disgust toward her, she might as well go sleep in the study for the night.

She had thought it through quite well, but their bedroom was pitch black, without even a trace of human presence.

Yan Lin held onto her last bit of hope and pressed the switch on the wall. The room lit up, and the bedroom was neat and clean with no changes at all - even her suitcase that she had casually left there hadn't been moved a bit.

Feng Yue hadn't slept in the bedroom for at least a week.

This thought suddenly popped into Yan Lin's mind. As if to prove something, she pushed open the bathroom door. The usually fully stocked vanity now only had her skincare products on it - other things belonging to Feng Yue were all gone.

Yan Lin turned and left the bathroom, then went to the walk-in closet.

Fortunately, Feng Yue's things were still there.

Yan Lin sat on the bed, looking at the empty bedside table, and for the first time felt an emotion called bewilderment.

She didn't know why Feng Yue wasn't sleeping in the bedroom, nor did she know why she had released that momentary disgust toward her. She had no answers.

Feng Yue had showered and was lying in bed looking at her phone when there came a knock at the door.

She looked at the tightly closed door for two seconds, then resignedly got out of bed to open it.

Sure enough, standing outside the door was Yan Lin wearing a bathrobe.

Yan Lin wore a black bathrobe, her black curly hair casually pinned into a bun at the back of her head, with loose strands still carrying some moisture.

Yan Lin stood at the door, appearing somewhat awkward. She looked at Feng Yue, her emotions unreadable, and after a long while said, "You..."

Seeing her frowning with an expression of not knowing how to begin, Feng Yue silently sighed in her heart, then said with feigned casualness, "After I got sick, I don't sleep very peacefully at night. I was afraid of disturbing you, so I moved to the guest room."

Yan Lin said nothing, just stared straight at her, as if trying to see through whether she was lying.

"You took a flight all day today, rest well. Don't you have to go to the company tomorrow?" Feng Yue lowered her gaze, and even her voice became somewhat cold, "Good night."

"...Good night."

Footnotes:

¹ **Intracranial pressure (颅内压):** The pressure inside the skull, which can become elevated due to brain tumors, swelling, or other medical conditions. Medications to reduce this pressure are commonly used in neurology.

